



English — Cbse English — Combined Half-Yearly (40 Marks)

Subject: English | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 40 | Time Allowed: 1h 30m | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. The paper has four sections: A (Reading), B (Writing), C (Grammar), D (Literature).
2. Sections A-C assess language skills; Section D assesses the prescribed textbook.
3. Attempt all sections. Internal choice is provided in the Writing section.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A — Reading Attempt all 1 questions. Each carries 10 mark(s).		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
1	<i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i> How Much Water a City Drinks Urban water demand is rising rapidly as populations swell and lifestyles shift. According to a 2021 report by the Central Ground Water Board, the average urban Indian consumes roughly 135 litres of water per day. This figure, however, masks significant variation across income groups and regions. Where does all this water go? A substantial portion is used for domestic chores. Bathing and washing account for nearly 40% of household water use, while toilet flushing alone consumes about 20%. Drinking and cooking represent a mere 5%, and the remaining 35% is distributed across cleaning, gardening, and incidental wastage. The environmental toll of this consumption is immense. Supplying 135 litres daily to a city of ten million people requires over 1.35 billion litres of treated water each day. Treating and pumping this water demands enormous energy, contributing to carbon emissions. Furthermore, much of the water drawn from groundwater aquifers is not replenished, leading to declining water tables. In Delhi, groundwater levels fell by an alarming 0.5 metres per year between 2012 and 2022. Sustainable urban living requires a shift in both behaviour and infrastructure. Rainwater harvesting, wastewater recycling, and fixing leaky pipes can drastically reduce the strain on municipal supplies. If every household recycled just 50% of its bathing water for flushing, a city could save millions of litres daily. Ultimately, understanding where our water goes is the first step toward ensuring that our cities do not run dry. (i) According to the 2021 report mentioned in the passage, what is the approximate daily water consumption of an average urban Indian? [2 mark(s)] (A) 50 litres (B) 1.35 billion litres (C) 135 litres (D) 0.5 litres (ii) Based on the passage, which combination of household activities accounts for 60% of daily water use? [2 mark(s)] (A) Drinking and cooking (B) Bathing/washing and toilet flushing (C) Cleaning and gardening (D) Incidental wastage and gardening (iii) Why does the author state that supplying water to a large city has an "immense" environmental toll? [2 mark(s)] (iv) Which word in the first paragraph means "hides" or "covers up"? [2 mark(s)] (A) masks (B) swell (C) distributed	10



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	(D) consumes (v) What is the main takeaway from the passage regarding urban water usage? [2 mark(s)]	
Section B — Writing Attempt 1 out of 1.		
2	Notice You are Vikram Singh, the Cultural Secretary of Sacred Heart School, Lucknow. The school's Annual Day function is scheduled for late November 2024. Rehearsals for various events — dance, music, and drama — need to begin soon. Draft a notice (60–90 words) informing all participating students about the rehearsal schedule, including dates, timings, venue, what to bring, and attendance requirements. Ensure the notice is formal and complete. <i>(Word limit: 60–90 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> OR Informal Letter You are Saanvi/Samar, a Class 9 student living at 8, Maple Avenue, Shimla. Your close friend Nitya/Nikhil, who lives in Delhi, has always encouraged your interest in science. You recently won the first prize at an inter-school science exhibition for your working model on rainwater harvesting. Write a letter to Nitya/Nikhil sharing this exciting news. In your letter, you should: • mention what the exhibition was, where it was held, and how many schools participated • describe your model and how you felt when your name was announced as the winner • invite your friend to visit Shimla during the winter break so you can celebrate together <i>(Word limit: 100–150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i>	5
Section C — Grammar Attempt all 5 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
3	___ by ambition, the young entrepreneur worked day and night to establish her startup in the highly competitive market. [Participles & Gerunds] (A) Driving (B) Driven (C) Having driving (D) Drives	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
4	Bad weather prevented us from ____ the journey, forcing us to stay back at the inn. [Participles & Gerunds] (A) resume (B) to resume (C) resumed (D) resuming	1
5	The scientist conducted the experiment ____ to ensure accurate results. [Adverbs] (A) careful (B) carefully (C) care (D) caring	1
6	____ the weather improve, the match will resume after lunch. [Conditionals] (A) Should (B) Had (C) Were (D) Did	1
7	Several traditional industries are struggling to survive; ____, the handmade textile sector has seen a remarkable revival due to growing demand for sustainable products. [Conjunctions] (A) therefore (B) consequently (C) similarly (D) however	1
Section D – Literature Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 2 mark(s).		
8	A painter is compared to a gardener because ____. <i>[Ch 6: Canvas of Soil]</i>	2
9	The phrase 'standing ovation' is an example of an adjective-noun collocation. Identify two other similar examples from the poem. <i>[Ch 10: Nine Gold Medals]</i>	2
10	Do you think Onula's support helped Sentila? If yes, why? If no, why not? <i>[Ch 3: The Pot Maker]</i>	2
11	The poet uses a metaphor in the line, 'The first step is the hardest'. Explain why this is metaphorical. <i>[Ch 16: Believe in Yourself]</i>	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
12	Choose whether the given statements display: fact-opinion or cause-effect. (i) I was diagnosed with a tumour in my spine. (ii) I had a surgery and was told that I would be bound to a wheelchair for the rest of my life. <i>[Ch 9: The World of Limitless Possibilities]</i>	2
13	What is the purpose of likening the mother's gaze to the sky? <i>[Ch 8: I Cannot Remember My Mother]</i>	2
14	How do you think Khetaram would feel about taking up this challenging task every day? <i>[Ch 13: Carrier of Words]</i>	2
15	What might be Shruti's father's reaction? Why? <i>[Ch 11: Twin Melodies]</i>	2
16	What is the impact of the refrain, 'she's peerless, let's praise her!'? <i>[Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]</i>	2
17	What is something that the elderly in your family cannot do easily but enjoy watching you do? <i>[Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]</i>	2

